

THE DIVINE NAMES: TIMES & SEASONS

A Spiritual Journey Through God's Names



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Introduction for Bonus Content

In church, we sing and shout about **Jehovah Jireh, Jehovah Shalom, Elohim, and El Shaddai**—but sometimes we don’t slow down long enough to ask, “*Okay... what does that actually mean for my life?*” This Youth Bonus “Bible Basics” section is designed to help you connect the dots: the **names of God**, the meaning behind **numbers** like 3, 7, and 40, and how God works through **times and seasons**—because God isn’t only for Sundays, and His Word isn’t only for grown-ups.

God is not distant and generic; He is personal and specific. Think about it like this: the same person can be called “Mom,” “Nana,” “Auntie,” “Best Friend,” or “Boss” depending on the relationship. Same person—different roles, different levels of closeness. In the same way, God reveals Himself through different names because He meets us in different moments: when you need peace, when you need direction, when you need strength, when you need help. The more you walk with Him, the more you learn how to call Him by what He has already been in your life.

Lesson 1: Names of God

You’ll learn what God’s names mean and why they matter—so your prayers stop sounding random and start sounding confident. This lesson helps you recognize how God shows up (peace, provision, healing, guidance) and reminds you: He’s not far... He’s faithful.

Lesson 2: Numbers, Times and Seasons

This lesson connects the “counting” language in scripture to real life—because wisdom isn’t just knowing *what* time it is, but knowing *what to do* with it. You’ll explore what numbers like **3, 7, 12, and 40** often point to, and how God uses seasons (waiting, growth, pruning, breakthrough) to shape you on purpose—one day at a time.

God is about relationship, not just ritual. So, here’s the challenge: *What do you think is true about God—and what does the Truth say?* These lessons are an invitation to move past a “God, fix it!” moment and into a real conversation with your Heavenly Father. He hears. He sees. He knows. As you explore His names and His timing—and what numbers often symbolize along the way—take notes, ask questions, look up the scriptures, and keep turning the page—because God isn’t trying to impress you; He’s trying to **meet** you.

Lesson 5: The Names of God:

Understanding the Sacred Language

Theme: Foundations of Faith

Background Text: Exodus 3:13–15; Isaiah 9:6; John 1:1–3; Isaiah 48:17

Key Verse: Exodus 3:14 (WEB)

¹⁴ God said to Moses, “I AM WHO I AM,” and he said, “You shall tell the children of Israel this: ‘I AM has sent me to you.’”

Appetizer – A Sacred Introduction

The names of God are not random titles — they reveal His identity, power, and relationship with His people. Ancient Hebrews viewed the name of God as so holy that it was never spoken aloud. Instead, they used *Adonai* (Lord) or wrote *G-d* — omitting the vowel to honor His sacredness.

Youth Reflection → How do you show reverence when speaking about or to God?

Main Course – Understanding the Divine Names and Titles

Bite 1 – YHWH (יהוה) – The Self-Existent One, Ex 3:14–15

God said to Moses, “I AM WHO I AM,” and he said, “You shall tell the children of Israel this: ‘I AM has sent me to you.’” God said moreover to Moses, “You shall tell the children of Israel this, ‘Yahweh, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, has sent me to you.’ This is my name forever, and this is my memorial to all generations.”

The personal name God revealed to Moses is represented by the four Hebrew letters *Yod-Hey-Vav-Hey* (YHWH).

In Hebrew, God’s personal name is written with four letters: Y-H-W-H (יהוה), often called the Tetragrammaton. Ancient Hebrew writing left out vowels, so over time people stopped saying this name out loud and read “Adonai” (“Lord”) instead. Later, scholars combined the consonants YHWH with the vowels from “Adonai,” and as the name passed through Latin into English, letters shifted—Y became J, and W was written as V—so the form “Jehovah” appeared in older Bibles. Today many scholars think the original pronunciation sounded more like “Yahweh,” but the key point is that God chose to share a personal name, showing He is not just a distant power but a God who wants to be known.

Bite 2 – Yeshua HaMashiach (יֵשׁוּעַ הַמָּשִׁיחַ), Matt 1:21

“²¹ She shall give birth to a son. You shall name him Jesus, for it is he who shall save his people from their sins.”

Yeshua means “Yahweh saves.” The English “Jesus Christ” is really “Jesus the Christ” — or Yeshua the Anointed One. “Christ” (Christos) and “Messiah” (Mashiach) are the same title in two languages — both mean “Anointed.”

Youth Reflection → Does understanding His Hebrew name deepen your faith in His mission?

Bite 3 – Ruach HaKodesh (רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ) – The Holy Spirit, Ps 51:11

Don’t throw me from your presence, and don’t take your Holy Spirit from me.

Literally “The Holy Breath.”

The word Ruach means “breath,” “wind,” or “spirit.” It signifies the living presence of God breathing life, comfort, and conviction into His people.

Youth Reflection → What areas of your life need the fresh wind of the Holy Spirit?

Bite 4 – YHWH Lammēd (יְהוָה לָמֵד) – The Lord Our Teacher, Isaiah 48:17

Yahweh, your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel, says: “I am Yahweh your God, who teaches you to profit, who leads you by the way that you should go...”

God is not only Savior but Teacher — revealing truth line upon line and leading us to wisdom.

Bite 5 – Selah (סֵלָה), Reflect, Ps 3:4

(WEB) I cry to Yahweh with my voice, and he answers me out of his holy hill. Selah.

Found 74 times in the Psalms, Selah means “pause and reflect.” It’s a divine rest stop — a spiritual breath meant for meditation.

Bite 6 – Amen (אמן), 2 Cor 1:20

²⁰ For however many are the promises of God, in him is the “Yes.” Therefore also through him is the “Amen”, to the glory of God through us.

From aman — “to confirm, to be faithful.”

When we say “Amen,” we declare “Let it be so” — aligning our agreement with God’s word.

Bite 7 – Hallelujah (הלל־יה), Ps 150:1

Praise Yah! Praise God in his sanctuary! Praise him in his heavens for his acts of power!

A compound of *Hallel* (praise) + *Yah* (short for YHWH). Meaning “Praise the Lord!” — it is the same in nearly every language, uniting all believers in worship.

Bite 8 – The True Vine, John 15:1

“I am the true vine, and my Father is the farmer.”

Yeshua identifies Himself as the source of life — the one through whom believers bear fruit.

Bite 9 – The Son of God, Matt 16:16

“You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.”

This title declares both His divinity and His relationship with the Father.

Dessert –What you need– He is, Isaiah 9:6

⁶ For a child is born to us. A son is given to us; and the government will be on his shoulders. His name will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace.

No matter how He is named — YHWH, Yeshua, Ruach HaKodesh, or Abba — His nature remains one: holy, eternal, and faithful.

Group Reflection → Which name of God speaks most to your current need or revelation?

Word Study

Term	Language	Meaning
YHWH (יהוה)	Hebrew	“I AM” – Self-existent One
Yeshua (ישוע)	Hebrew / Aramaic	Yahweh Saves
Ruach HaKodesh (רוח הקדש)	Hebrew	Holy Spirit / Breath of God
YHWH Lammēd (יהוה למד)	Hebrew	The Lord Our Teacher
Selah (סֵלָה)	Hebrew	Pause and Reflect
Amen (אָמֵן)	Hebrew	Let It Be So / Truly
Hallelujah (הללוֹיָהּ)	Hebrew	Praise the Lord
Abba (אָבָא)	Aramaic	Father / Intimate One
Mashiach (מָשִׁיחַ)	Hebrew	Anointed One
Emmanuel (עִמָּנוּאֵל)	Hebrew	God With Us

Historical Sidebar

(Tetra – what? Def: the Hebrew name of God [transliterated](#) in four letters as **YHWH** or **JHVH** and [articulated](#) as **Yahweh** or **Jehovah**)

Language Stage	Rendering of Jesus’ Name	Approx. Century
Hebrew	Yeshua (ישוע)	Before 1st Century
Greek	Iesous (Ἰησοῦς)	1st Century
Latin	Iesus	4th Century
English	Jesus	16th Century

The letter *J* evolved from the letter *I*, first appearing in print around 1524. Jewish scribes avoided writing God’s full name to prevent misuse — hence *G-d*.

Group/Personal Reflection Questions

Why is God’s name written as *G-d* or *YHWH* in Hebrew tradition?

How does *Yeshua HaMashiach* deepen your understanding of salvation?

What does *Ruach HaKodesh* reveal about God’s closeness to His people?

To-Go Box

- How you refer to a person can change as you get closer together
- YHWH, Adonai, Savior, Elohim – becomes more the deeper your relation is to the Lover or your and Creator of all things
- Challenge yourself weekly to dedicate seeing God as more than the “man upstairs” but as your Lord and your friend

Author's Testimony

A lady I met in church befriended me when attending our family church, Antioch Holiness Church, in Cross, SC. My grandma, Pearl was battling breast cancer, and Sis Shepherd felt inspired to invite me to a teens Christian youth camp. We drove to Raliegh/Durham area, and I had the opportunity to fellowship with girls 12-17 years old at a weekend sleepover. The youth counselors showed us that God can use our faith to perform miracles!

People whose limbs were short, became lengthened, folks dealing with pain was healed. We laid hands and saw Jehovah Jirreh, at work! The I Am, that I Am just needed our faith. Your age, your gender, or social status are not roadblocks for the move of God, it's your level of faith, and the absence of doubt.

Bonus Lesson — Times & Seasons:

God’s Order in Days and Numbers

Theme: Foundations of Faith

Background Text: Genesis 1:14–19; Genesis 8:22; Leviticus 25:8–13

Key Verse: Ecclesiastes 3:1 (WEB)

“For everything there is a season, and a time for every purpose under heaven.”

Appetizer – The Rhythm of the Kingdom

God is a God of order, and the way He measures time is deeply spiritual. The same God who created oceans and galaxies also created schedules, seasons, and rhythms—because life works better when it follows His design.

In Genesis, God said the sun and moon were made for “signs and seasons” (appointed times). When God delivered Israel from Egypt, He even reset their calendar—teaching them that deliverance is not just an event; it’s a new beginning. When we learn God’s patterns, we stop guessing about our lives and start paying attention to what He’s doing in our season.

Main Course

Bite 1 — God’s Order in Numbers

God is intentional down to the details—down to the hairs on your head. If He cares about the small things, it makes sense that numbers in Scripture often carry patterns and meaning. These patterns don’t replace the Word; they help us notice God’s fingerprints in the story.

Number	Meaning	Scripture Example
1	Unity; Beginning	Deuteronomy 6:4
2	Witness; Agreement	Matthew 18:19
3	Divine Completeness	Matthew 28:19
4	Creation; Divine Order	Revelation 7:1
5	Grace	Genesis 43:34
6	Man; Labor	Revelation 13:18
7	Perfection; Rest	Genesis 2:2
8	New Beginnings	2 Peter 2:5
9	Fruitfulness; Judgment	Galatians 5:22

10	Law; Responsibility	Exodus 20:1–17
12	Government; Authority	Revelation 21:12
40	Testing / Transition	Matthew 4:2
50	Jubilee; Freedom	Leviticus 25:10

Youth Thought: God uses numbers and patterns to show us that He is intentional about the details of our lives. Your current “wait” may actually be a “40-day” preparation for your “8th-day” new beginning.

Bite 2 — Calendar & Seasons

In Western culture, we often think of a day as sunrise to sunrise. In biblical Jewish culture, a day is often counted from sunset to sunset. That’s why many Jewish holidays begin at sundown. It’s a reminder that God can start something new in what looks like “night.”

Associating biblical times, seasons, and celebrations with our calendar helps bring the Word to life—because God is not only the God of “back then,” but the God of right now. As you look at the months and cycles, notice how God keeps repeating the same message: freedom, formation, repentance, and renewal.

Jewish Month	Gregorian Equivalent	Primary Focus / Festival
1. Nisan	March / April	Passover, Unleavened Bread, Firstfruits
2. Iyar	April / May	Counting the Omer
3. Sivan	May / June	Shavuot (Pentecost / Giving of the Law)
4. Tammuz	June / July	Fast of the 17th of Tammuz
5. Av	July / August	Tisha B'Av (Temple remembrance)
6. Elul	August / September	Repentance / Preparation for Rosh Hashanah
7. Tishrei	September / October	Rosh Hashanah, Yom Kippur, Sukkot
8. Cheshvan	October / November	A “quiet” month (no major feasts)
9. Kislev	November / December	Hanukkah (Feast of Dedication)
10. Tevet	December / January	Fast of the 10th of Tevet
11. Shevat	January / February	Tu B'Shevat (New Year for Trees)
12. Adar	February / March	Purim (Esther’s victory)

Note: Tishrei (September/October) begins the civil year with Rosh Hashanah. In some leap years on the Hebrew calendar, an extra month is added to keep the lunar cycle aligned with the solar seasons.

Season (Cycle)	Key Holidays / Observances	Scripture Reference (examples)
Spring: Redemption	Passover + Unleavened Bread	Exodus 12; Leviticus 23
Late Spring / Early Summer: Covenant & Harvest	Shavuot (Feast of Weeks)	Leviticus 23; Deuteronomy 16
Summer: Reflection	A season of reflection and remembrance	Psalms 90:12 ("count our days")
Fall: Repentance & Ingathering	Trumpets / Atonement / Tabernacles themes	Leviticus 23
Winter: Dedication / Light	Feast of Dedication (Hanukkah) themes	John 10:22
Late Winter / Early Spring: Turning / Joy	Purim (deliverance)	Esther 9
Land-Cycle (multi-year)	Sabbath year & Jubilee patterns	Leviticus 25

Youth Thought: Every number and every month can become a reminder that God is intentional. When we see the patterns, we stop guessing about our lives and start governing our choices with wisdom and prayer.

Reflection

In looking at seasons—and what you now know about different calendars—what stands out to you, and how could it change the way you pray or plan your next steps?

Dessert — The Year of Jubilee, Leviticus 25:10

“You shall make the fiftieth year holy, and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee to you...”

God’s timing is designed to lead to freedom, not fatigue. Jubilee was a reset—debts canceled, land restored, and people released. It was a real-life picture of God’s heart: restoration over defeat.

Youth Reflection: Where do you need God to “reset” something in your life—your mind, your habits, your schedule, or your hope?

To-Go Box

- Seasons are temporary; God’s purpose is eternal.
- God’s timing is designed to produce freedom, not exhaustion.
- Pay attention to the patterns—God often speaks through the rhythm of your life.

Word Study

Mo’ed (Hebrew) – An appointed time, season, or festival.

Activity – Times & Seasons Check (YE)

Part A – Match the Number

Match each number to its common biblical theme:

- A. 7 ___ Completion / rest
- B. 8 ___ New beginnings
- C. 12 ___ Government / authority
- D. 40 ___ Testing / transition
- E. 50 ___ Jubilee / freedom

(Answers are in the Holiday YE Answer Key Appendix.)

Part B – Short Answer

1) What does Mo'ed mean?

2) What does Shabbat mean?

3) In your own words, what is Jubilee (Leviticus 25), and what does it show us about God?

Part C – Multiple Choice

In Genesis 1:14, God said the lights in the sky were created for:

- a) Just decoration
- b) Signs and seasons, days and years
- c) To control people's moods
- d) None of the above

Part D – Personal Check-In

Which “season” word (planting, waiting, pruning, harvest) describes you right now, and why?

Prayer

“Lord, thank You that my times are in Your hands. Thank You that You are a God of order, purpose, and perfect timing. Help me recognize what You’re doing in this season and respond with wisdom. Amen.”

Holiday Edition – YE Activity Answer Key Appendix

Use this appendix for grading, prep, or quick reference.

Reflection questions and open-ended activities do not have fixed “right” answers.

Bonus Lesson — Youth Names of God (Answer Key)

Activity 1 – Fill in the Blank

1. There is no letter J in the Hebrew alphabet.
2. The name Yeshua means “Yahweh saves.”
3. The Holy Spirit in Hebrew is called “Ruach HaKodesh.”
4. Selah means “pause and reflect.”
5. Amen means “Let it be so” (or “truly”).

Activity 2 – Name Match

- YHWH → “I AM” / Self-Existent One / covenant name of God
- Hallelujah → “Praise the Lord”
- Emmanuel → “God with us”
- Abba → “Father” / intimate, close term

Activity 3 – True / False

- a) “Christ” and “Messiah” both mean “Anointed One.” → True
 - b) Ruach HaKodesh means “God with us.” → False (It means “Holy Spirit / Holy Breath.”)
-

Bonus Lesson — TIMES & SEASONS (Answer Key)

Activity – Times & Seasons Check (YE) — Answer Key

- Part A – Match the Number
- 7 → Completion / rest
- 8 → New beginnings
- 12 → Government / authority

40 → Testing / transition

50 → Jubilee / freedom

Part B – Short Answer

Mo'ed → an appointed time / season

Shabbat → rest (Sabbath)

Jubilee → a reset: liberty + restoration (Leviticus 25)

Part C – Multiple Choice: Genesis 1:14 → b) Signs and seasons, days and years (Part D: personal response)

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Reference & Study Resources

Historical, linguistic, and cultural insights for the instructors and teachers- extended study materials have been formed by standard biblical reference works, concordances, and reputable academic sources, as outlined in the Reference & Historical Source Index (Instructor Edition) for this series. These tools were used under educational Fair Use to provide context, clarity, and enrichment for teachers and students alike.

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